

JIAYI LU

jiayi.lu@northwestern.edu

ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

Assistant Professor

2025-present

Department of Linguistics, Northwestern University

Affiliated: Cognitive Science Program

Postdoctoral Fellow

2024-2025

Department of Linguistics, University of Pennsylvania

Advisors: Julie Anne Legate, Charles Yang

EDUCATION

PhD in Linguistics

2024

Department of Linguistics, Stanford University

Dissertation Committee: Judith Degen (Chair), Michael C. Frank, Daniel Lassiter, Thomas Wasow

BA in Linguistics, Neuroscience, Integrated Science

2019

summa cum laude

Northwestern University

Thesis advisors: Masaya Yoshida, Shayne Sloggett

Linguistics Summer Session

2017

Universiteit Utrecht

The LSA Linguistics Institute

2017

University of Kentucky

RESEARCH INTERESTS

(Formal and Experimental) Syntax, Psycholinguistics,

PUBLICATIONS

†: Student author *: Equal contributions

Yang, X.[†], **Lu, J.** (accepted). Islands Satiety without Change in Backgroundness. *Glossa*

Lu, J., and Kim, N. (2026). Adjunct Island Effect on Wh-Scrambling in Korean. *Glossa* 11(1)

Lu, J., Legate, J.A., and Yang, C. (2026). The Learnability of Bridge Effects. *Journal of Linguistics*, 1–43.

Lu, J.*, Pan, D.*, and Degen, J. (2025). Evidence for a Discourse Account of Manner-of-Speaking Islands. *Language* 101(4): 627–659

Lu, J., Frank, M., and Degen, J. (2024). Which Islands Satiety: a Meta-Analysis. *Glossa Psycholinguistics* 3(1): X, 1–33

Lu, J., Merchan, J., Wang, L., and Degen, J. (2024). Can Syntactic Log-Odds Ratio Predict Acceptability and Satiation?. *Society for Computation in Linguistics* 7(1): 10-19

Kim, N., and **Lu, J.** (2024). Coordination of Unlike Categories Creates Grammaticality Illusion. *Korean Journal of English Language and Linguistics* 24(1): 52–61

Zhan, M., Chen, S., Levy, R., **Lu, J.**, and Gibson, E. (2023). Rational Sentence Interpretation in Mandarin Chinese. *Cognitive Science* 47(12): e13383.

- Kim, N., Li, Z., and **Lu, J.** (2023). Island-Sensitivity of Two Different Interpretations of *Why* in Chinese. *Frontiers in Psychology* 13: 1059823.
- Lu, J.**, Wright, N., and Degen, J. (2022). Satiation Effects Generalize Across Island Types. *Proceedings of the 44th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society*: 2724–2730.
- Lu, J.**, and Kim, N. (2022). The Puzzle of Argument Structure Mismatch in Gapping. *Frontiers in Psychology* 13: 907823.
- Kim, N., and **Lu, J.** (2022). Predictive Sentence Processing: Evidence from Passive Relative Clause Processing. *Korean Journal of English Language and Linguistics* 22(1): 70–85.
- Kim, N., and **Lu, J.** (2021). An Illusion of Grammaticality in Wh-Questions. *Korean Journal of Linguistics* 46(3): 607–618.
- Lu, J.**, Lassiter, D., and Degen, J. (2021). Syntactic satiation is driven by speaker-specific adaptation. *Proceedings of the 43rd Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society*: 1493–1499.
- Lu, J.**, Thompson, C.K., and Yoshida, M. (2020). Chinese Wh-in-situ and Islands: a Formal Judgment Study. *Linguistic Inquiry* 51(3): 611–623

UNPUBLISHED MANUSCRIPTS

- Lu, J.** (2022). An Adjunction Analysis of Clause Chaining in Turkish. Second PhD Qualifying Paper.
- Lu, J.** (2021). Satiation as Rapid Syntactic Adaptation. First PhD Qualifying Paper.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

†: Student author *: Equal contributions

- Dowling, R.†, **Lu, J.** (2027). Cataphoric Pronoun Suspends the Ban on [-Human] Non-obligatory Control. Talk to be presented at the 2027 Linguistics Society of America (LSA) Annual Conference, San Francisco, CA.
- Wang, A.†, Davis, F., and **Lu, J.** (2027). Real-time Evidence for Good-enough Lexical Representation. Talk to be presented at the 2027 Linguistics Society of America (LSA) Annual Conference, San Francisco, CA.
- Lu, J.**, Yang, X.†, and Kim, N. (2027). Real-time Satiation of the That-trace Effect: Evidence for the Adaptation Account of Satiation. Talk to be presented at the 2027 Linguistics Society of America (LSA) Annual Conference, San Francisco, CA.
- Ronai, E.*, **Lu, J.***, Wang, A.†, and Feng, J.† (2026). Evidence for Adaptation in Scalar Implicature Calculation. To be presented at the 2026 Experiments in Linguistic Meaning (ELM) conference, Philadelphia, PA.
- Yang, X.†, **Lu, J.** (2026). Island Satiates without Change in Backgroundedness. To be presented at the 2026 Human Sentence Processing (HSP) conference, Cambridge, MA.
- Lu, J.** (2026). Availability of Acceptable Alternatives Modulates Satiation. The 2026 Linguistics Society of America (LSA) Annual Conference, New Orleans, LA.
- Lu, J.**, Legate, J.A., and Yang, C. (2025). Examining the bridge/non-bridge verb distinction in Mandarin Chinese. The 38th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP), College Park, Maryland.
- Lu, J.**, Papineau, B., Jeong, S., Hernandez, A., Goodwin, E., and Anttila, A. (2025). Interspeaker Variation in Copular Agreement with Disjoined Subjects: an Optimality-Theoretic Account. The 2025 Linguistics Society of America (LSA) Annual Conference, Philadelphia, PA.

- Lu, J.***, Merchan, J.*, Wang, L.*, and Degen, J. (2024). Can Syntactic Log-Odds Ratio Predict Acceptability and Satiation?. The 2024 Meeting of the Society for Computation in Linguistics (SCiL), Irvine, California.
- Merchan, J.*, Wang, L.*, **Lu, J.***, and Degen, J. (2024). Can Language Model Surprisal Predict Acceptability and Satiation. The 2024 California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP), Stanford, California.
- Yao, R., **Lu, J.**, and Degen, J. (2024). Perceived interpretability predicts satiability for Complex NP island but not Whether-island. The 2024 California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP), Stanford, California.
- Lu, J.***, Pan, D.*, and Degen, J. (2024). Evidence for a Discourse Account of Manner-of-Speaking Islands. The 2024 Linguistics Society of America (LSA) Annual Conference, New York City, New York.
- Pan, D.*, **Lu, J.***, and Degen, J. (2023). Discourse Foregrounding Ameliorates Manner-of-Speaking Islands. The 36th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP), Pittsburg, PA.
- Lu, J.**, and Degen, J. (2023). Which Islands Sate: a Meta-analysis. The 2023 California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP), Los Angeles, California.
- Pan, D.*, **Lu, J.***, and Degen, J. (2023). Can Manner-of-Speaking Islands be Rescued Through Discourse Foregrounding?. The 2023 California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP). Los Angeles, CA.
- Lu, J.**, and Degen, J. (2023). Which Island-violating Sentences Sate: a Meta-analysis. The 2023 Linguistics Society of America (LSA) Annual Conference, Denver, Colorado.
- Lu, J.**, and Kim, N. (2023). Coordination of Unlike Categories Creates Grammaticality Illusion. The 2023 Linguistics Society of America (LSA) Annual Conference, Denver, Colorado.
- Lu, J.**, Wright, N., and Degen, J. (2022). Satiation effects generalize across island types. The 44th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society, Toronto, Canada.
- Wright, N., **Lu, J.** and Degen, J. (2022). What is the representational target of island satiation effects?. The 35th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP), Santa Cruz, California (Online).
- Lu, J.** and Kim, N. (2022). Maximizing Parallelism in the Processing of Gapping: Evidence from Argument Structure Mismatches. The 2022 Linguistics Society of America (LSA) annual conference, Washington, D.C.
- Lu, J.** (2021). Reducing conjunct islands to adjunct islands: Evidence from Turkish. The 2021 Linguistics Society of America (LSA) annual conference, San Francisco, California (Online due to COVID-19).
- Lu, J.**, Lassiter, D., and Degen, J. (2021). Satiation of Island Constraints is Partially Syntactic Adaptation. The 2021 Linguistics Society of America (LSA) annual conference, San Francisco, California (Online).
- Lu, J.**, Walenski, M., and Thompson, C.K. (2019). EEG Evidence for Different Syntactic Expectations in Parsing Chinese Subject and Object-relative Clauses. The International Brain and Syntax Think Tank, Evanston, Illinois.
- Lu, J.**, Thompson, C.K., and Yoshida, M. (2019). Examining Argument-Adjunct Asymmetry of Island Effect in Mandarin Chinese. The 2019 Linguistics Society of America (LSA) Annual Conference, New York City, New York.
- Lu, J.**, Thompson, C.K., and Yoshida, M. (2018). Chinese Wh-in-situ and Islands: a Formal Judgment Study. The 2018 Annual Conference on Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP), Berlin, Germany.

Lu, J., Walenski, M., and Thompson, C.K. (2018). EEG Evidence for Different Syntactic Expectations in Parsing Chinese Subject and Object-relative Clauses. The 2018 Society of Neurobiology of Language (SNL) annual conference, Quebec City, Canada.

Lu, J. and Ward, G. (2018). *Verb Meaning and Subject-Position Zero-Pronoun Comprehension in Mandarin Chinese*. The 2018 Southern California Undergraduate Linguistics Conference (SCULC), Los Angeles, California.

Lu, J. (2017). Processing Asymmetry in Mandarin Chinese Relative Clauses: A Literature Review and Suggestions for Future Studies. The 2017 Great Lakes Expo for Experimental and Formal Undergraduate Linguistics Conference (GLEEFUL), East Lansing, Michigan.

INVITED TALKS

Probing the Satiation of Island Effects 2025
Princeton University, New Jersey

**From Input to Change:
How Input Shapes Linguistic Knowledge and Language Use** 2025
Department of Linguistics and Cognitive Science, Pomona College, California

Discourse Effects on the Manner-of-Speaking Island 2024
Speech and Sentence Processing Lab, University of California, Santa Cruz, California

An Adjunction Analysis of Clause Chaining in Turkish 2023
Syntax and Semantics Circle (SSCircle), University of California, Berkeley, California

Discourse Effects on the Manner-of-Speaking Island 2023
Language and Cognition Lab, Sungkyunkwan University, South Korea

Discourse Effects on the Manner-of-Speaking Island 2023
School of Foreign Studies, Nanjing University, China

AWARDS, SCHOLARSHIPS, AND GRANTS

Integrated Language Sciences and Technology (ILST) Travel Grant, University of Pennsylvania 2025

Integrated Language Sciences and Technology (ILST) Small Grant, University of Pennsylvania 2025

Graduate Research Opportunity Grant (\$4,850), Stanford University 2023 - 2024

Centennial Teaching Assistant Award, Stanford University 2023

Departmental Research Grant (\$1,000), Stanford University Department of Linguistics 2020

Phi Beta Kappa, Northwestern University 2019

Community Service Award, Northwestern University Integrated Science Program 2019

Fletcher Undergraduate Research Award, Northwestern University 2017

Abraham Demoz Prize in Linguistics, Northwestern University 2017

Academic Year Undergraduate Research Grant (\$1,000 each), Northwestern University 2017, 2019

GLEEFUL Conference Travel Award, Michigan State University 2017

Excellence in Mathematics by a First Year Student, Northwestern University 2016

Dean's List: 2015 Fall to 2019 Spring (12 Quarters), Northwestern University 2015 - 2019

SERVICE

Journal Reviewer

Canadian Journal of Linguistics, Folia Linguistica, Frontiers in Psychology, Glossa Psycholinguistics, Journal of Cognition, Journal of East Asian Linguistics, Journal of Linguistics, Journal of Memory and Language, Language, Languages, Lingua, Linguistic Inquiry, Linguistics: An Interdisciplinary Journal of the Language Sciences, Natural Language & Linguistic Theory, PLOS One, University of Georgia Working Papers in Linguistics, Zeitschrift für Sprachwissenschaft.

Conference Reviewer

Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP) 2026, Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci) 2022 - 2025, California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP) 2021 - 2025, Linguistics Society of America Annual Meeting (LSA) 2025 - 2026, Penn Linguistics Conference (PLC) 2025 - 2026, West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL) 2022 - 2025.

Conference Organizing Committees

6th California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP 6)	2024
40th West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL 40)	2022

Departmental Service

Colloquium Committee, Northwestern Linguistics	2026 - 2027
Department 50 th Anniversary Event organizer, Northwestern Integrated Science Program	2026
QP Fest Committee, Stanford Linguistics	2023
Undergraduate mentor TA, Stanford Linguistics	2022 - 2024
Colloquium Committee, Stanford Linguistics	2021 - 2022
Application reviewer and mentor, Stanford CSLI Summer Internship Program	2021 - 2022
Coordinator for Stanford Syntax and Morphology Circle (SMircle)	2020 - 2022
Social Committee, Stanford Linguistics	2019 - 2020
Weinberg College Student Advisory Board, Northwestern University	2018 - 2019
Integrated Science Program Student Programming Board, Northwestern University	2018 - 2019
Coordinator for Syntax Club, Northwestern Linguistics	2017 - 2019

TEACHING AND MENTORING

As primary instructor:

Northwestern University

LING 400: Seminar: Linguistics Adaptation	2026 Spring
LING 460: Syntactic Analysis	2026 Winter
LING 360: Fundamentals of Syntax	2025 Fall
GEN-LA 298: Alternative Science: Pseudoscience, Parascience, and Fringe Science	2018 Spring

University of Pennsylvania

LING 2500: Introduction to Syntax	2024 Fall
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Stanford University

LINGUIST 196: Introduction to Undergraduate Research	2023 Winter, Fall
LINGUIST 195A: Undergraduate Research Workshop	2023 Winter, Spring, 2024 Winter, Spring

As teaching assistant:

Stanford University

LINGUIST 130B: Introduction to Lexical Semantics (Instructor: Cleo Condoravdi)	2024 Spring
LINGUIST 121A: The Syntax of English (Instructor: Bonnie Krejci)	2023 Spring
LINGUIST 130: Introduction to Semantics and Pragmatics (Instructor: Chris Potts)	2022 Winter
LINGUIST 145: Introduction to Psycholinguistics (Instructor: Judith Degen)	2020 Fall

Graduate students:

Anzi Wang	2025-present
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Undergraduate research advisees:

Ruby Dowling	<i>2026-present</i>
Xiaohan Yang	<i>2025-2026</i>
Jonathan Merchan (Stanford University)	<i>2023</i>
Lian Wang (Stanford University)	<i>2023</i>
Ruoqing Yao (College of William and Mary, through the Stanford CSLI program)	<i>2022</i>
Nicholas Wright (College of William and Mary, through the Stanford CSLI program)	<i>2021</i>

OTHER RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Massachusetts Institute of Technology (Advisor: Ted Gibson)	<i>2018</i>
Summer Research Intern	
Northwestern University (Advisor: Masaya Yoshida)	<i>2017-2019</i>
Research Assistant	
Northwestern University (Advisor: Cynthia K. Thompson)	<i>2016-2019</i>
Research Assistant	

SKILLS

Languages	Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent), Turkish (research knowledge), Japanese (research knowledge), Samoan (research knowledge) Korean (research knowledge)
Programming Languages	Python, javascript, HTML, WebPPL
Software and Tools	L ^A T _E X, R, ELAN, Praat, OTSoft